

2022 annual review

Benton received an overall rating of “exceeds expectations.” Voss credited her with standardizing remediation reviews and closing thirty-nine of forty-one assigned audits on time. The review identified client communication and evidence organization as strengths.

A development item asked Benton to delegate more planning work and seek additional lead designations. No discipline, warning, or client-confidence concern appears. Benton completed eighteen travel days and maintained both listed professional credentials.

The 2022 review predates the protected activity and provides historical context rather than a direct measure for the 2025 RIF.

2023 annual review

Benton again received “exceeds expectations.” She led the remediation-quality initiative and closed forty-four of forty-seven audits on time. Voss wrote that Benton was dependable during multi-site work and could stabilize troubled engagements.

The review recommended recording Benton's actual leadership when she replaced another project lead. It noted that formal lead credit did not always match work performed. Benton traveled twenty-four days and accepted four short-notice substitutions.

No performance-improvement plan or attendance issue was recorded. The review did not compare her salary with peers.

2024 annual review

The final pre-RIF review rated Benton “strong performer,” one level above “meets expectations.” She closed forty-seven of fifty audits on time, an audit-completion rate of 94 percent, and led remediation work on Northline and Oriole.

Voss praised Benton's control analysis, team coaching, and client-ready documentation. The review listed one December short-notice trip Benton declined because she was conducting a scheduled closeout. It did not characterize the event as unreliability.

The review awarded lead-credit points based on the company’s recorded designation, while noting Benton had disputed whether the designation captured planning and field work.

Audit completion detail

The 2024 tracker lists fifty Benton matters: forty-seven timely, two delayed by client document holds, and one delayed by a Blue Cedar staffing gap. The RIF import excluded client-controlled delays and assigned 27 of 30 completion points.

Comparable timely-close figures were Wynn thirty-eight of forty-three, Ibarra thirty-five of forty-two, and Keene thirty-six of forty. None of the four had a failed regulatory deliverable.

The tracker contains no March 2025 correction reducing Benton's completion result. The final B-7 workbook compares weighted scores but identifies no new missed audit or changed timely-close row.

Client feedback and transition records

Northline's January survey rated Benton's team 4.7 of 5 and asked her to remain through the June remediation handoff. Oriole rated the team 4.5 and scheduled final validation for June 27. Neither client complained about confidence or communication.

Lantern rated Wynn's team 4.6 and scheduled its transition to finish May 30. The client records show all three transitions mattered; they do not explain why the earlier-ending Lantern matter received more final continuity credit.

A March 25 internal message transferred Northline to Wynn and Oriole to Ibarra without recording client cancellation or revenue loss.

Availability, travel, and scheduling

Benton completed twenty-eight approved travel days in 2024, more than each comparator. She accepted three assignments offered with fewer than five business days' notice. On December 19 she declined a next-day trip because she was leading a scheduled closeout approved by Voss.

The scheduling record marks the decline "conflict—manager assigned elsewhere," not unwillingness. Another manager covered the trip without delay. No written policy required Benton to abandon an existing client commitment.

The RIF calibration nevertheless reduced her availability score from 12 to 6 and increased Ibarra's from 9 to 14 based on his stated willingness for future travel.

Credentials, advancement, and succession notes

Benton held active internal-auditor and regulatory-controls credentials and received 14 of 15 credential points. In November 2024 Voss identified her as ready for broader remediation-quality leadership if a director role opened.

The succession note praised Benton's ability to train managers on exception analysis. Keene was listed as backup for automation reports; Benton was listed as backup for quality review and client remediation. The RIF later treated Benton's review function as transferable while giving Keene the maximum uniqueness score.

No performance record labels Benton a poor performer. The March 24 termination register separately marks performance action “none” and rehire eligibility “yes.”